

SUCCESSION, READINESS, PROMOTION & INTERNAL MOBILITY

Succession & Internal Mobility Design

Make better decisions about who is ready for what comes next.

Most organizations have talented people. The harder question is whether leaders share a clear definition of readiness, use credible evidence to assess it, and apply those standards consistently when succession, promotion, and mobility decisions are made.

Corework helps organizations strengthen the criteria and decision processes underneath those choices, creating greater confidence in who is ready now, where the pipeline is thin, and what people need to develop before taking on greater responsibility.

Who is actually ready for what comes next, and how do we know?

When Talent Decisions Become Difficult to Trust

The succession process may exist, but leaders use different definitions of "ready." The same names appear year after year. Promotion decisions depend heavily on individual judgment. Internal mobility happens inconsistently across teams. Development is weakly connected to the roles people are expected to grow into.

This engagement may be a fit when:

- Readiness criteria are unclear or inconsistently applied
- Succession slates repeatedly surface the same people
- Promotion decisions depend heavily on individual leader judgment
- Internal mobility happens inconsistently across teams or functions
- Development investments are weakly connected to future roles
- Leadership lacks a clear view of where the pipeline is strong or vulnerable

Succession	Readiness	Mobility	Promotion
DECISIONS	CRITERIA	MOVEMENT	EVIDENCE

The Corework Approach

Corework examines how readiness and advancement decisions work today: what leaders say they value, what evidence they actually use, and how succession, promotion, and mobility decisions get made in practice. Evidence gathering and redesign happen together so the new approach is grounded in real decisions, not a theoretical model.

01

Define Readiness

Clarify what "ready for the next level" actually means for the roles or leadership levels in scope. Identify the capabilities, experiences, evidence, and performance expectations that should distinguish readiness from potential, strong current performance, or tenure.

02

Test Current Decisions

Examine how succession, promotion, and mobility decisions are currently made. Where are common criteria used? Where do standards vary? What evidence carries weight in practice? Where do precedent, informal influence, or advocacy shape the outcome?

03

Redesign the Decision Process

Create clearer criteria and a more consistent way to apply them. Strengthen how readiness is assessed, discussed, calibrated, documented, and translated into actual succession, promotion, and mobility decisions.

04

Connect Readiness to Development

Use the clearer readiness model to strengthen development and pipeline planning. Leaders gain a better basis for identifying what people need to demonstrate or develop before they are ready for greater responsibility.

What Readiness Has to Clarify

Readiness becomes more useful when leaders are explicit about the evidence behind the judgment. Depending on the roles in scope, Corework helps the organization clarify four elements:

Capabilities What must the person be able to do at the next level?	Experiences What kinds of work, responsibility, or exposure provide useful evidence of readiness?
Evidence What observed results or behaviors should support the judgment?	Performance Expectations What should distinguish readiness for the next role from strong performance in the current one?

What the Organization Receives

The specific outputs depend on the leadership levels and decisions in scope, but the engagement is designed to strengthen both the standards and the process behind advancement decisions.

Core Deliverables

- Clearer readiness criteria for the roles or leadership levels in scope
- Defined evidence standards for assessing readiness
- A stronger process for succession, promotion, and mobility decisions
- Practical guidance for calibration and decision discussions

Pipeline & Development Outputs

- Clearer connection between development and future-role readiness
- Better visibility into pipeline strengths, gaps, and development priorities
- Greater consistency across leaders or business units
- Recommendations for embedding the redesigned approach into ongoing talent processes

The result is greater confidence in both who is ready now and how the organization builds readiness over time.

The Corework Difference

Succession planning often concentrates on who is on the list. Corework also examines the system producing the list. Are leaders assessing the same things? Is readiness defined clearly enough to evaluate? Does the evidence support the judgment? Are comparable decisions being made using comparable standards? And does development actually prepare people for the criteria that will determine whether they advance?

Strengthening those connections makes succession and mobility more useful in day-to-day talent decisions, rather than periodic exercises that generate names without increasing confidence in the pipeline.

What Client Participation Looks Like

Corework Typically Needs

- A senior sponsor who can define the decisions and leadership populations in scope
- Access to current succession, promotion, mobility, or readiness criteria and related process materials
- Targeted stakeholder interviews with leaders who make or influence advancement decisions
- Leadership working sessions to test and refine the redesigned approach

The Work May Also Include

- Review of current talent-review or calibration practices
- Sample decision review where access allows
- Existing pipeline, mobility, or promotion data relevant to the scope
- Alignment with current leadership-development or capability frameworks

WHERE THE LEADERSHIP PATHWAY FITS

Clear readiness criteria make development more purposeful. If the primary need is building leadership capability for people preparing to take on greater responsibility, Corework may recommend the Leadership Pathway as a complementary or follow-on engagement.

Engagement Scope

Succession & Internal Mobility Design is a project-based advisory engagement. Scope is shaped around the decisions the organization needs to trust and the leadership populations those decisions affect.

Leadership Levels in View

A focused engagement may address one critical transition, while broader work may span several leadership levels.

Organizational Complexity

The number of functions, business units, or talent processes involved affects the depth of review and redesign.

Decisions in Scope

Succession, promotion, and internal mobility may be addressed together or through a more focused engagement.

Project-Based ADVISORY ENGAGEMENT	Review + Interviews EVIDENCE BASE	Leadership Sessions REDESIGN WORK	Fixed Fee SCOPED TO COMPLEXITY
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What Is Included

Core Engagement

- Sponsor kickoff and scope alignment
- Review of agreed succession, readiness, promotion, and mobility materials
- Targeted stakeholder interviews
- Leadership working sessions to test and redesign criteria and process

Outputs

- Readiness criteria and evidence standards
- Redesigned decision process and calibration guidance
- Pipeline and development implications
- Recommendations for embedding the approach into ongoing talent processes

Investment

Focused engagements begin at \$75,000. Final investment reflects the leadership populations and decisions in scope, organizational complexity, stakeholder involvement, and the depth of review and redesign required. Broader multi-level, cross-functional, or enterprise engagements are scoped separately.

Expanded stakeholder research, additional leadership populations, deeper decision review, implementation support, and multi-business-unit or multi-geography work may increase scope and investment.

WHAT IT IS NOT

This is not simply a talent review, a replacement-box exercise, or a workshop that generates another succession list. The engagement strengthens the criteria and decision processes underneath readiness, promotion, and mobility so leaders can make those decisions with greater consistency and confidence.

Need Greater Confidence in Succession and Mobility Decisions?

Start with the decisions your leaders need to trust.

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